(ii) Distribution of quality seeds of high yielding varieties (HYVs) and hybrids;

(iii) Popularisation of newly released varieties, support for micro-nutrients; and

(iv) Training and mass media compaign including awards for best performing districts.

The Mission gives flexibility to the identified districts to adopt any local area specific interventions as are included in the Strategic Research and Extension Plan (SREP) prepared for the agriculture development of the district. During the Eleventh Plan period, the total outlay of NFSM is Rs. 4,882.5 crore.

Q. 26 Write a concise note on the recently launched Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana.

Ans. There has been a declining trend in the governments' share of investment in the agriculture sector for the past few decades due to various reasons. The issue has been a matter of great concern for the governments in recent times. It was highly contemporary that the National Development Council (NDC) in its 53rd meeting (early 2007) decided to launch a programme to incentivise the states to increase the share of investment in agriculture in their state plans. Accordingly, on August 16, 2007 the Government approved the *Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana* (RKVY) with an allocation of Rs. 5,000 crore for the Eleventh Plan period.

The RKVY *aims* at achieving the 4 per cent annual growth rate in the agriculture sector during the Eleventh Plan by ensuring a holistic development of agriculture and allied sectors.

This is a State Plan Scheme and the eligibility for assistance under the scheme would depend upon the amount provided in the State Budgets for agriculture and allied sectors, over and above the baseline—percentage expenditure incurred on the sectors. The funds under the scheme would be provided to the states as *100 per cent grant* by the Central government. The main objectives of the scheme are as given below:

(i) Incentivising the states to increase public investment in the agriculture and allied sectors;